

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1211

By Martin G

A RESOLUTION to recognize Joe Smith on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should pause to honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of public service; and

WHEREAS, Joe Smith is one such estimable person, who has served the citizens of District 3 in Hamilton County with distinction over the past ten years as a member of the Hamilton County Schools Board of Education; and

WHEREAS, during his fruitful tenure, Mr. Smith served on the Hamilton County Schools Board of Education with acumen and alacrity, first as a member, then as vice chairman for two years, and most recently as chairman for three years, in which roles he always endeavored to prioritize children and serve in their best interest; and

WHEREAS, for a decade, Mr. Smith was a driving force behind boosting student achievement, supporting strategic planning and budget leadership, improving transportation and operations, and investing in employee culture; and

WHEREAS, in 2019, Hamilton County Schools became the fastest-improving district in the State with record TVAAS growth, showing proficiency increases in all core subjects, with more than half of the schools meeting or exceeding growth expectations; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Smith proudly supported the development and implementation of Future Ready Institutes and Opportunity 2030 to expand innovative career pathways in area high schools; championed historic TISA funding investments to support students, teachers, and classroom needs; endorsed opportunities that raised student scholarships from \$66 million in

2015 to more than \$184 million in 2024; and supported programs that have led to a ninety-four-percent graduation rate, the highest in the district's history; and

WHEREAS, under his astute guidance, Hamilton County Schools not only experienced a dramatic rise in student athletics success, increasing state championships sixfold since 2015 and upgrading school athletic facilities throughout the county, but also became a regional leader in school transportation; and

WHEREAS, Joe Smith supported expansion to nineteen community schools, providing wraparound services through partners such as Northside Neighborhood House, OnPoint, the University of Tennessee at Chattanooga, and Communities In Schools; and

WHEREAS, in addition to providing long-term community solutions through major facility projects, capital investments, and infrastructure improvements, Mr. Smith helped raise the district's employee retention rate and implement both health and mental health programs to support employees; and

WHEREAS, his many professional accomplishments aside, Mr. Smith is most grateful for the love and support of his wife, Paula Smith; and

WHEREAS, Joe Smith exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Mr. Smith has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his colleagues and the citizens of Hamilton County; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Joe Smith for ten years of dedicated public service as a member of the Hamilton County Schools Board of Education and wish him every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.